

Do's & Don'ts: From Application to Closing

From application to keys, your financial life is a museum exhibit — look, don't touch. If something must change, call your loan officer first.

DON'T

- ✗ Apply for or take out any new loans
- ✗ Pay off collections or debt unless your lender says to
- ✗ Consolidate debt or close credit cards
- ✗ Dispute items on your credit report
- ✗ Make large deposits other than payroll — no cash
- ✗ Make large purchases with credit or debit
- ✗ Move money between accounts
- ✗ Change jobs without talking to your loan officer
- ✗ Quit or give notice before your loan closes
- ✗ Use cash for earnest money — check or wire only

DO

- ✓ Make all your payments on time
- ✓ Tell your lender if you haven't filed last year's taxes, or owe on them
- ✓ Tell your lender if anything about your job is changing
- ✓ Keep homeowners insurance at or under the Loan Estimate amount
- ✓ Return everything your lender asks for quickly

The one that does the most work: the biggest predictor of a smooth closing isn't your score or your down payment — it's how fast you send documents back. Same-day beats perfect.